

# WHAT IS A 5 WHY ANALYSIS?



# WHAT IS 5 WHY ANALYSIS?

**5 WHYS IS AN ITERATIVE PROBING TECHNIQUE TO GET TO THE ROOT CAUSE(S) OF AN EFFECT OR A PROBLEM**

**THE ANSWER TO THE FIRST “WHY” UNCOVERS ANOTHER REASON AND GENERATES ANOTHER “WHY”. IT OFTEN TAKES FIVE “WHYS” TO ARRIVE AT THE ROOT CAUSE(S) OF THE PROBLEM**



# WHAT IS 5 WHY ANALYSIS?

**TRUE PROBLEM SOLVING REQUIRES IDENTIFYING “...ROOT CAUSE’ RATHER THAN ‘SOURCE’; THE ROOT CAUSE LIES HIDDEN BEYOND THE SOURCE”**

**FOR EXAMPLE, YOU MAY FIND THAT THE SOURCE OF A PROBLEM IS A SUPPLIER OF A PARTICULAR MACHINING CENTER – THE PROBLEM OCCURS THERE**

**BUT WHAT IS THE ROOT CAUSE OF THE PROBLEM?**

**THE ANSWER LIES IN DIGGING DEEPER BY ASKING WHY THE PROBLEM OCCURRED**

# WHY TO USE 5 WHY ANALYSIS?

**HELPS IDENTIFY TRIVIAL MANY ROOT CAUSES**

**IT'S A SIMPLE PROBING TECHNIQUE**

**HELPS TEAM COLLECTIVELY REACH ROOT CAUSE(S)**

**DETERMINES THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THE DIFFERENT ROOT CAUSES OF A PROBLEM**

**ONE OF THE SIMPLEST TOOLS, EASY TO COMPLETE WITH NO STATISTICAL ANALYSIS REQUIRED**

# WHEN TO USE 5 WHY ANALYSIS?

**DETERMINE THE CAUSE & EFFECT RELATIONSHIP OF A PROBLEM**

**YOU WANT TO GET TO THE ROOT CAUSE(S) OF AN EFFECT OR PROBLEM WITHOUT USING STATISTICAL ANALYSIS**

**YOU WANT TO UNCOVER ROOT CAUSE(S)**